Toolbox Card

Eight tools for starting a problem

AGES 8-10



1 Spot the pattern

Look for what repeats or changes by the same amount, then say the rule.



2 List every way

List all the possibilities in an organised order and say how you know you have them all.



3 Draw it

Draw a picture, bar model or number line that shows what is known and what is asked.



4 Make a table

Make a table, fill it row by row and look down the columns.



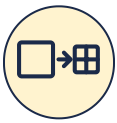
5 Work backwards

Start from the answer and undo each step in reverse order, then check forwards.



6 Guess and check

Make a sensible guess, check it against every clue, improve it.



7 Try something simpler

Solve a smaller version first, then see what changes as it grows.



8 Act it out

Use objects, folding or a role-play to see what happens, then record it.

Look back

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AGES
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Pick one problem from today. There are no right answers. You can pass. Nobody reads it out.

1. **Did I answer what was asked?**
2. **Does my answer make sense? (Is it about the right size?)**
3. **Can I check it another way?**

I checked by ... Use a pencil.

When I am stuck

- **Wait.**
- **Try a tool.**
- **Try a smaller case.**
- **Ask.**

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